

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO GPUS,
IT'S ALL HERE...

Tech-love

THIS MONTH IN TECH: We start off with the latest in mobiles, apps, and gadgets, then we move on to NVIDIA Volta, take a quick journey through the origins of mapping, talk to some interesting startups, show you how to install Android O beta, 3D print your own phone case, compare flagship phones, see what Agent001 has to say, get inside the Nintendo Switch, follow up on our look at careers in Information Security... and so much more. Heck this section alone is as good as an entire magazine!

Google I/O 2017

Google's yearly developer conference was kicked off with a wide array of announcements, ranging from VR activities to AI everywhere, and how Photos is growing faster than Chrome. Here are some of the biggest announcements from the I/O keynote.

Android O: The first public beta of Android O is officially available now. So if have a compatible Pixel or Nexus device, you can download it and explore all the latest features. See our workshop to help you do that later in this issue.

Google Assistant: Google's AI Assistant that was only available on Pixel phones and Google Home last year, is expanding its presence to more devices and apps. Interestingly, it will also be available for iOS.

Virtual Reality: Google wants to get rid of all the hassle with VR right now like needing a decent-enough PC, jungle of wires or even smartphones to power one. New standalone Daydream VR headsets are in development. HTC and Lenovo will be the first to deliver them.

Google Lens: Perhaps the most interesting launch from the event, the new Google Lens app uses the Assistant and added computer vision elements to identify the world around you. So, pointing to a flower will tell you its name, while pointing to a restaurant will give ratings.

New Chip for AI: Sunder Pichai, Google's CEO, announced a new Tensor Processing Unit (TPU) – this is a special chip meant for Google's TensorFlow AI platform.



Android Go: Basically a new OS designed to work on devices with 1GB of RAM or less, and targeted at the extreme budget smartphone or feature-phone market.

More at <http://dgit.in/GIO2017>

Wireless charging roads?

The biggest drawback to owning an electric vehicle right now is big, expensive and very limited charge batteries, and of course limited charging points. The Israeli government is working with ElectRoad (an Israeli startup), to try out under-pavement wireless charging technology, so that the roads can charge the cars! With constant charging available, there would be no need for heavy, high-capacity batteries that have to sustain the vehicle over long distances. Instead, we could switch to cheaper, lighter batteries even on heavier vehicles. Granted, setting this up would be a huge one-time investment, but it would eventually pay off in the long run. Of course, this can only be done in smaller countries, and not in India with our massive road network. Maybe someday?

<http://dgit.in/WirelessBus>

